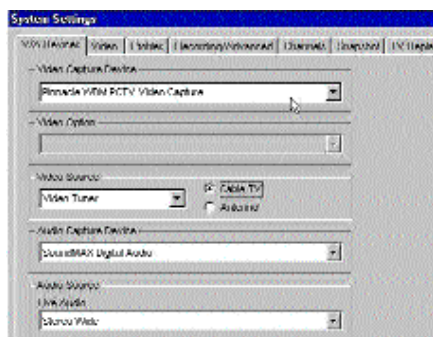


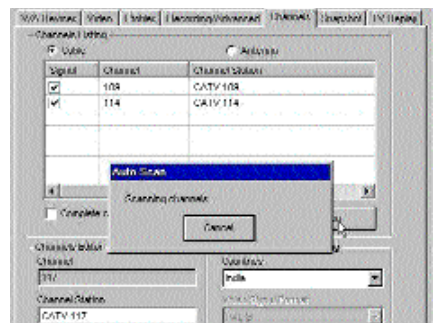
time, the system settings menu opens up and allows you to enter the settings.

To check and see if the card is correctly recognised by the software, go to the System Settings menu and under the V/A Devices tab you should be able to see the TV Tuner card in the Video capture device menu. V/A Devices sets the configuration for all video and audio devices. Set video source as Composite Video, and click on Cable. Also check the audio settings.



V/A Devices tab shows the TV Tuner card

The Channels tab lists available stations in your area and allows you to name specific channels. Under Video Signal Format Setting, select India. This would automatically set the Video Signal Format for India, which is PAL B. You can then choose the Cable option and click on Auto Scan. The application will scan across all available input signals and list them out in the Channel Listing table. As the auto scan proceeds, you will be able to see the video feed in the main viewer panel. Once set, you can view the video, but hold on—you haven't set the other options yet.



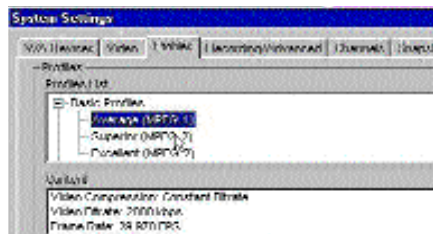
Auto Scan detects available video signals

Under the Video tab, you can change the options for brightness, contrast, hue and saturation. Now you can also set the snapshot and TV replay options. Go to Snapshots and set the options for where you want the screen captures to be stored—these can be used later to sort through archived videos.

Under the TV Replay tab, set the Replay Buffer Time/Disk Space options. Remember, the minimum amount of space required is 500 MB for 10 minutes of replay time. Set the Replay Buffer Time/Disk Space to the highest possible, subject to the free disk space available. You may also want to change the Replay Working Directory.

The Profiles tab allows you to set the quality of encoding raw video footage coming in through the TV Tuner card. There are several default profiles and you can also define your own.

You should apply a profile that best suits the hardware you have. A rule of thumb is to use MPEG-1 for low resolutions (normal usage) and MPEG-2 for high resolutions. For example, if you have a machine that is not too high in processing power and system resources, settle for the Average profile—at MPEG 1, the picture quality is still reasonably good. Likewise, if you have a machine that's absolutely state-of-the-art, go ahead and choose the Superior profile, at MPEG-2. If you want to further specify the quality of the encoding, you can do so by trying out the other options under Advanced and DVD Profiles. You could also set custom values for video and audio compression, bit rates, frame rates, frame sizes and other parameters. Remember though, for recording at resolutions such as 640x480 and upwards, you need to have at least a Pentium III 700 MHz-class processor.



Set the profile that best suits your hardware

Although you can leave the settings at their default values, you should consider experimenting with some customised options to take advantage of your hardware and get better results.

Director's cut

Ever seen something on TV that you wanted to see again? Like a football goal you just can't believe? Or maybe a catch that you just missed seeing? Those are the times that you wished you could replay 'live' TV! Your PVR can actually do that! Switch to the Instant TV Replay mode and



Jargon Buster

Television standards: Television standards used around the world vary. Unfortunately, video recorded in one particular format is not normally compatible with another format. The television standards are:

■ **PAL:** Based on a 50 Hz power system, PAL (Phase Alteration Line) is the standard format for television broadcasts in Asia and Western Europe. By reversing the relative phase of the colour signal components on alternate scanning lines, it avoids the colour distortion that occasionally appears in NTSC broadcasts.

■ **NTSC:** NTSC (National Television Systems Committee) is a standard format adopted by the FCC for television broadcasts in the United States, Japan, Canada and Mexico. This is commonly referred to as Composite Video because of the convergence of luminance and colour into a single analog signal.

■ **SECAM:** SECAM (Sequential Couleur a Memoire or Sequential Colour with Memory) is the video format used in France, Eastern Europe and some Middle Eastern countries. Like PAL, SECAM is based on a 50 Hz power system. Colour signals are transmitted sequentially.

MPEG: MPEG (Moving Picture Experts Group) is a compression technology for digital video and audio signals. It includes the following standards: MPEG-1 (Audio/Video), MP3 or MPEG-1 Audio Layer 3 (Audio), MPEG-2 (Audio/Video), MPEG-4 (Interactive Multimedia System). MPEG is responsible for multiplexing and synchronising one video stream with a single or multiple audio streams. MPEG-1 was designed to reproduce VHS/VCR quality in digital format, while the MPEG-2 concept, similar to MPEG-1, is intended to cover a wider range of applications with DVD quality and broadcast TV.

Composite Video Signal Format:

Generally used for less expensive types of video devices, it produces a single video signal. Used in VHS camcorders or VCRs.

Digital Video Format: Digital video signals are split up into three components: luminance, luminance minus red and luminance minus blue. The component video signals can create a picture free of common distortions that result from combining and then separating the video signal components. This technology is used for DVDs.